Standard Operating Procedure

AZ 205 Customer Complaint Procedure			
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Revised By:		(SIGNATURE)	Date:

Review & Approval

Functional Manager	**Ruben Urias**	(SIGNATURE)	Date: 8/19/2025

1. PURPOSE

This procedure establishes a systematic process for receiving, logging, investigating, and resolving customer complaints related to food safety, product quality, handling, or service at each HubStarr Logistics 3PL warehouse facility identified in the current facility roster (individually and collectively, the "Facilities"). This procedure supports the customer complaint requirements of the PrimusGFS Standard, Module 1 (Section 1.05.05 of v3.2 as of issue).

2. SCOPE

Applies to all customer complaints received at the Facilities involving stored product condition, food safety, cross-contamination, temperature deviation, pest activity, allergen concerns, foreign material, documentation errors, or any other issue affecting product integrity or customer satisfaction, and to all HubStarr Logistics personnel who receive or handle customer communications.

3. DEFINITIONS

Customer Complaint: Any verbal or written expression of dissatisfaction from a customer or client regarding product condition, food safety, service, or regulatory compliance originating from or relating to HubStarr warehouse operations.

Complaint Severity (Critical / Major / Minor): Defined, with required response timeframes, in Section 7.

CAPA: Corrective and Preventive Action -- documented root cause analysis and measures taken to prevent recurrence.

PCQI: Preventive Controls Qualified Individual, designated for HubStarr Logistics (see current designee roster).

4. RESPONSIBILITIES

PCQI: Process owner; approves CAPA for Critical and Major complaints; issues final customer response for Critical events.

Sr. Compliance: Conducts or oversees investigation; coordinates with accounts; maintains Customer Complaint Log; ensures timely closure.

FS/Account Leads: First point of receipt for facility-level verbal complaints; complete intake notes; escalate Critical complaints immediately.

Warehouse Supervisors: Preserve product evidence; place implicated inventory on hold; support on-site investigation.

All Personnel: Report any complaint or customer dissatisfaction to a supervisor or FS Lead immediately upon receipt.

5. COMPLAINT RECEIPT

5.1 Accepted Channels. Complaints may be received at either Facility by any means, including telephone, email, in person, written or customer-portal submission, or internal escalation by a HubStarr employee raising a condition on the customer's behalf.

5.2 Initial Intake. The receiving employee shall record the date, time, name and company of the caller/sender, product/lot/order involved (if known), and a brief description of the issue, and deliver the intake record to Sr. Compliance by end of business day — immediately for Critical complaints.

5.3 Escalation Protocol. Critical: FS Lead or on-duty Supervisor notifies the PCQI and Sr. Compliance within 2 hours of receipt. Major and Minor: intake notes to Sr. Compliance by end of business day.

DO NOT make commitments to the customer regarding cause, liability, or remediation without PCQI or Sr. Compliance approval.

6. COMPLAINT LOGGING

6.1 Customer Complaint Log. Sr. Compliance shall enter all complaints into the Customer Complaint Log maintained in the compliance document management system within one business day of receipt. Required fields: Complaint ID (CC-YYYY-###), Facility, date received, date logged, customer/client name, contact info, product/lot/order (if applicable), complaint description, severity classification, assigned investigator, status (Open / Under Investigation / Closed), and closure summary.

6.2 Product Hold. If a complaint implicates a specific lot or pallet, the Warehouse Supervisor shall immediately place the product on hold per the On-Hold / Rejected Items Log. Product shall not be released until PCQI or Sr. Compliance authorizes release in writing per AZ-141 Product Release for Shipment.

7. SEVERITY CLASSIFICATION

Upon receipt of intake notes, Sr. Compliance assigns severity:

CRITICAL -- Potential food safety hazard: illness/injury, confirmed or suspected contamination (biological, chemical, physical, or allergen), pest activity involving product, temperature abuse of temperature-sensitive product, or regulatory violation. Response within 24 hours. PCQI must be notified. Evaluate whether recall/withdrawal procedures apply.

MAJOR -- Significant product quality defect, product damage, incorrect shipment, documentation discrepancy affecting traceability, or repeated service failures. Investigation and response within 5 business days.

MINOR -- Isolated service or documentation issue with no food safety or significant quality implication. Resolution within 10 business days.

If severity escalates during investigation, update the log and re-escalate per the protocol above.

8. INVESTIGATION

8.1 Investigation Steps. Sr. Compliance (or PCQI-designated investigator) shall conduct an investigation proportional to severity, including:

a) Review of receiving records, temperature logs, inventory/lot records, shipping records, and relevant checklists for the implicated product or time period at the applicable Facility.

b) Interviews with relevant personnel and physical inspection of implicated storage zones, equipment, or processes at the implicated Facility.

c) Collection and retention of physical evidence (samples, photos, labels) as applicable.

d) Review of applicable SOPs, work instructions, and training records for compliance gaps.

e) For Critical complaints, the PCQI determines whether recall/withdrawal procedures must be activated.

8.2 Root Cause Determination. The investigator shall document a root cause determination (e.g., 5-Why analysis, fishbone diagram). Root cause categories may include: personnel error, equipment failure, process gap, supplier/vendor issue, environmental condition, or documentation deficiency. If root cause cannot be definitively established, document analysis performed and most probable cause.

9. CORRECTIVE AND PREVENTIVE ACTION (CAPA)

9.1 CAPA Development. Based on root cause, Sr. Compliance shall develop a CAPA that includes:

Immediate corrective action to address the complaint and prevent continuation, and preventive action to address the systemic cause and prevent recurrence (e.g., SOP revision, additional monitoring, process modification).

Responsible party, target completion date, and verification method for each action item.

9.2 CAPA Approval and Implementation. Critical and Major complaints: CAPA must be reviewed and approved by the PCQI before implementation. Minor complaints: Sr. Compliance may approve and implement. All CAPA actions shall be documented in the Customer Complaint Log and in the Corrective Action Register or the equivalent corrective action log then in use.

9.3 CAPA Effectiveness Verification. Sr. Compliance shall verify CAPA effectiveness within 30 days of implementation by reviewing relevant monitoring records and confirming no recurrence. Verification findings shall be documented in the Complaint Log. If CAPA is found ineffective, the investigation shall be reopened.

10. CUSTOMER NOTIFICATION AND RESPONSE

10.1 Acknowledgment. Critical and Major complaints: Sr. Compliance shall send written acknowledgment within 2 business days of receipt confirming the complaint is under investigation.

Minor complaints: Verbal or email acknowledgment within 5 business days.

10.2 Resolution Communication. Upon completion of investigation, Sr. Compliance (or PCQI for Critical complaints) shall provide the customer with a written response summarizing: investigation outcome, root cause determination (to the extent appropriate to disclose), corrective and preventive actions taken or planned, any product disposition decisions, and timelines for remaining actions. All customer communications shall be retained as complaint records.

11. TREND ANALYSIS AND MANAGEMENT REVIEW

Sr. Compliance shall compile a complaint summary at least quarterly, covering all Facilities, reporting: total complaints by severity and category, open vs. closed status, recurring complaint types, and CAPA effectiveness. This summary shall be presented to the PCQI and included in the annual food safety management system review. Recurring trends shall trigger evaluation of corresponding preventive controls.

12. RECORDS RETENTION

Minimum retention: 3 years (or as required by customer contract or regulatory requirement, whichever is longer). The following records shall be retained:

Customer Complaint Log (all entries); original complaint intake notes (email, written, or handwritten); investigation records, photos, and evidence; CAPA documentation and effectiveness verification records; customer communications (acknowledgment and resolution letters); and product hold, release, or disposition records related to the complaint.

Records shall be retained in the compliance document management system, in the designated Customer Complaints records location.

13. RELATED DOCUMENTS

AZ-141 Product Release for Shipment; On-Hold / Rejected Items Log; Customer Complaint Log; PrimusGFS Standard, Module 1 (customer complaint requirements); Corrective Action Register.

- **Document History:**

Revision	Change	Effective date
ORG	**Initial Release - AZ-205 Customer Complaint Procedure**	8/19/2025

This process is required to be reviewed, at a minimum, on a 3-year cycle. If there are no changes to the previous revision the signature below is evidence of the review and approval of this procedure.

Reviewed By: _____ Date _____

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